

First year as Faculty

Federica Zoe Ricci
Swarthmore College



Where we're going

01

Context

Where am I? How does this compare to your interests?

02

Culture

Getting to know your new university and department

03

Finding harmony

Between teaching, research, and service

04

Community

Finding a community of mentors / peers to uplift you

05

Your turn

Discussion about what you're expecting, questions you have, etc.

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About Me



Federica Zoe Ricci

Assistant Professor of
Statistics

Swarthmore College



01 Context Swarthmore College

Context

- Small Liberal Arts College
- ~1600 undergrads
- 25 min train ride from Philadelphia



Context

- **Teaching-focused** undergraduate university with expectation of **scholarship** and contribution to **community building and governance**
- ~ 60/30/10



Context

- Dept. of Mathematics and Statistics
- 17 math + 5 stat faculty
- Math major with Stat concentration
- No Data Science program (yet!)
- Stat methods I and II are *service courses*



Context

Teaching

- “Highly selective”
- 2-2 (semester)
- Courses capped at ~35
- Graders



Context

Research

- Peer-reviewed papers
- Research on: Methods + Applications + Stat Ed
- Talks, conference participation
- Grants Office support (not required)
- Student research (encouraged)



Context

Service

- Department “jobs”
- Campus-wide committees



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02

Culture

Take time to get to
know your department
& university

Culture



University norms



Departmental norms

Culture



University norms



Departmental norms

Culture



University norms

Liberal arts vs. universities,
business/engineering
schools



Departmental norms

Culture



University norms

Where does Statistics fit?



Departmental norms

Culture



University norms

Contract renewal &
tenure timeline



Departmental norms

Culture



University norms

Interactions between
faculty across
departments



Departmental norms

Culture



University norms

Grades



Departmental norms

Culture



University norms



Departmental norms

New courses?
Semester preps?

Culture



University norms



Departmental norms

What service expectations for (visiting) assistant professors?

Culture



University norms



Departmental norms

Best ways to be heard as
an assistant professor?

Culture



University norms



Departmental norms

How is teaching
evaluated?

Culture



University norms



Departmental norms

What are inclusive
teaching practices that
my colleagues
implement?

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A woman in a black suit is balancing on a tightrope. She is looking to her right, and her arms are outstretched to maintain balance. In the background, there are two large, dark gray circles. The scene is set against a light gray background.

04

Finding harmony

Between teaching,
research, and service

Finding harmony



Teaching



Research



Service

Finding harmony



Teaching



Research



Service



You can do what you want!

Finding harmony



Teaching

😊 You can do what you want!

😱 You can do what you want!



Research



Service

Finding harmony



Teaching

- What teacher are you?

*Who teaches like you like?
Can you find their materials?*



Research



Service

Finding harmony



Teaching

- What teacher are you?
- Office hours: when/what?

What are your colleagues' approaches?



Research



Service

Finding harmony



Teaching

- What teacher are you?
- Office hours: when/what?
- Emails, exams, AI..



Research



Service

What are your colleagues' approaches?

Finding harmony



Teaching

- What teacher are you?
- Office hours: when/what?
- Emails, exams, AI..



Research



Service

***Ask to observe your
colleagues!***

Finding harmony



Teaching



Research



Service

😊 You can do what you want!

😱 **You can do what you want!**

Finding harmony



Teaching



Research



Service

- Give yourself time and grace
- Off-teaching day(s)
- Try work with collaborators
- Focus on few selected projects
- Go to conferences and give talks
- Ask for promotion details

Finding harmony



Teaching



Research



Service

- Department
- College: "Shop" for committees
- Say no?
- Paper reviews, conference organizing

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05

Community

Finding a community of
mentors / peers to
uplift you

Community

- Find **mentors** to help you along the way
- *Department* mentor?
- *University* mentor?
- *External* mentor?



Community

- Find **mentors** to help you along the way
- Many **Statistics mentoring programs** exist! (ex: ASA Sections)



Community

- Find **peers** to help you along the way
- Junior faculty at your institution?
- Junior faculty elsewhere?



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fricci1@swarthmore.edu

Feel free to
reach out!

